

CANNING FRUITS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What type of canner is used to safely preserve most fruits at home?

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ANSWER

Boiling water canner

FUN FACT

A boiling water canner keeps fruit safe by cooking jars in hot boiling water.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we add lemon juice when canning Asian pears?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because Asian pears are lower in acid and need extra acid for safe canning

FUN FACT

Adding lemon juice helps keep the canned fruit safe and tasty.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the difference between a raw pack and a hot pack in canning fruit?

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ANSWER

Raw pack uses raw fruit packed into jars; hot pack uses fruit heated in syrup or juice before packing

FUN FACT

Hot packing helps remove air and can give better fruit texture after canning.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

How much headspace should you leave at the top of the jar when canning fruit?

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ANSWER

1/2 to 1 inch to allow for expansion during processing

FUN FACT

Headspace is space left between the food and jar top to help form a good seal.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What happens if you don't keep the water boiling the entire time during water bath canning?

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ANSWER

The fruit might not be processed enough, which can cause spoilage.

FUN FACT

Keeping the water boiling helps kill harmful microbes in canned fruit.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

Why do we preheat jars before filling them with fruit for canning?

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ANSWER

To prevent jars from breaking when adding hot fruit or liquid

FUN FACT

Hot jars help fruit stay hot and safe while sealing.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

Which is a safe sugar syrup option for canning fruit?

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ANSWER

Light syrup made by dissolving sugar in water

FUN FACT

Syrups help keep fruit texture and add sweetness during canning.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What should you do if a jar of canned fruit doesn't seal properly?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Refrigerate and use soon or reprocess with a new lid within 24 hours

FUN FACT

Unsealed jars can spoil, but reprocessing helps keep your food safe.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

Why is it important to use standard Mason jars for canning fruit?

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ANSWER

They are heat-tempered and seal properly with canning lids

FUN FACT

Special canning jars are strong and made to keep out air and germs.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

When using a boiling water canner, where should the water level be compared to the jars?

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ANSWER

1 to 2 inches above the jar tops

FUN FACT

Water above jars keeps the temperature steady and helps jars seal.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

How long should empty jars be boiled to sterilize them if processing fruit less than 10 minutes?

CANNING FRUITS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Boil 10 minutes to sterilize jars

FUN FACT

Sterilizing jars kills bacteria that can spoil food quickly.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What is the purpose of draining fruit in ascorbic acid solution before packing?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To prevent fruit from darkening (browning)

FUN FACT

Ascorbic acid keeps fruit looking bright and fresh in jars.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

Why should you never use white-flesh peaches for boiling water canning?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They have low acid levels and no safe boiling water canning time

FUN FACT

White-flesh peaches are safer frozen than canned to avoid food risks.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What is the recommended volume of syrup, water, or juice to add to each jar of berries when canning?

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ANSWER

1/2 cup

FUN FACT

Adding liquid helps cover berries and keep the fruit firm.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do screw bands need to be removed from jars after canning and sealing?

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ANSWER

**To prevent rusting on the lids
and allow air flow**

FUN FACT

*Removing bands helps keep seals
safe and jars rust-free.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Q

What is a sign that a jar lid has sealed correctly after canning fruit?

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ANSWER

The center of the lid is concave (popped down) and does not move when pressed

FUN FACT

A sealed lid keeps air out so fruit stays fresh longer.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

When processing fruit in a boiling water canner, what do you do if the water stops boiling in the middle of processing?

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ANSWER

Bring water back to a boil and start timing the process over from the beginning

FUN FACT

A steady boil ensures microbes get killed properly.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What temperature should water be preheated to for raw pack and hot pack fruit before filling the jars?

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ANSWER

140°F for raw pack, 180°F for hot pack

FUN FACT

Preheating helps prevent jar breakage when filling them.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What will happen if old or damaged canning lids are used?

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ANSWER

**They may not seal properly,
causing spoilage**

FUN FACT

Only new lids should be used to keep jars sealed and food safe.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

Why do you have to wait about 5 minutes after turning off the heat before removing jars from the canner?

CANNING FRUITS

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ANSWER

To let pressure and temperature settle for safe jar removal

FUN FACT

Waiting keeps jars from cracking or spilling hot fruit liquid.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits